

The pitch speech

Three minutes in the room, done by 2:50. Slides 2 to 8 follow it line by line, and the same words are in each slide's speaker notes. The amber tags tell you when to click. Slides 9 and 10 (architecture, data privacy) are for the assessors: the deck has 10 slides, the organisers' limit.

Problem	Solution	Demo video	Cost and ask	Stand out	Close
0:00	0:28	0:55	1:45	2:06	2:27

About 440 words at a steady pace, plus 50 seconds of video. If you run long, slow down anyway and cut "Payment apps take cards."

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0:00–0:28

Slides 2–3

Problem and evidence

Everyone wants a piece of the informal market. Big retailers are moving into townships. Banks and payment apps are fighting for its customers. Because it's worth about R900 billion a year.

SLIDE 3 But the people who run it can't prove any of it. It runs on cash and word of mouth. Fewer than one in ten can get a bank loan. A spaza owner can't get stock on credit, and a builder can't prove the houses he's built.

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0:28–0:55

Slide 4

Solution

SLIDE 4 Akayza is one free app for the whole informal market. Spaza shops and food sellers are matched with suppliers who deliver. Builders log every job with photos, and clients sign off each stage.

POINT AT THE BAND You know airtime advance: your network lends you airtime because it's seen that you always pay. Akayza builds that kind of history for a business. Every paid order and signed-off job adds to a record the owner holds: the first step to credit, better suppliers and new clients.

Demo

BUSINESS TYPE Akayza works for any kasi business. Meet Sipho, who runs a kota shop by the taxi rank.

LOCATION PIN He picks Food, and drops a pin where he trades.

SUPPLIERS Akayza shows him suppliers who deliver to him.

ORDER AND PAY He orders bread from a bakery that delivers, and pays in the app. The payment provider confirms it, and his invoice arrives.

ORDER BOOK At the counter, every kota he sells goes in his order book.

MY RECORD It all adds up in his record, with the confirmed payments marked.

BUILDER JOB Now meet Thabo, a builder. Every job, stage by stage, is photographed, and the client signs off each stage from a link: confirmed by both. That's his track record.

Cost and ask

SLIDE 6 Businesses use Akayza for free. Suppliers pay: from R299 a month, plus about 1% on digital orders, never on cash. Next, lenders pay to see a business's record, only with the owner's consent.

For a six-month pilot in Soshanguve, with 2 suppliers and 50 to 100 businesses, we need R300,000: field agents, stipends for pilot businesses, data, running costs and a POPIA review.

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2:06–2:27

Slide 7

Why we stand out

SLIDE 7 Ordering apps give traders a place to buy. Payment apps take cards. Akayza gives the informal market something it's never had: a record people can trust. Payments are confirmed by the payment provider, and job stages by both sides, so it's more than a receipt. And the record belongs to the owner: nothing goes to a lender without their consent.

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2:27–2:50

Slide 8

Close

SLIDE 8 Richard Maponya started in the 1950s with a milk business in Soweto. His customers trusted him, and decades later he opened Maponya Mall. The next Maponya is out there right now: selling kotas, running a spaza, laying bricks.

Everyone wants a piece of the informal market. Akayza makes sure the people who run it keep theirs. We don't hold the stock. We build the record. Keep it in the kasi.

Look at the panel, not the screen. Then stop talking.

FACT CHECK

What changed from your draft, and why

The angle is yours and it stays. Every change below fixes a number we can't source, a feature the app doesn't have yet, or a team rule.

YOUR DRAFT	NOW	WHY
worth an estimated R600 to R750 billion a year	about R900 billion a year	The verified figure: Standard Bank's Township Informal Economy Report, October 2025. It's on slide 2.
seven in ten households buy from it	Fewer than one in ten can get a bank loan	We found no source for seven in ten. Under 9% with bank-loan access is verified (same report) and it's on slide 3.
a vendor can't get ingredients on credit	a spaza owner can't get stock on credit	Team rule: always name spaza shops and builders, never street vendors.
Sipho, who sells kotas at the taxi rank; sets up his stall	Sipho, who runs a kota shop by the taxi rank; picks Food	Same rule. Food is a real business type at sign-up.
every order is confirmed by both sides	clients sign off each stage; payments confirmed by the provider	Only job stages are confirmed by both today. Cash confirmed between a trader and a supplier isn't built yet.
places his first order on credit	orders bread from a bakery that delivers, and pays in the app	Ordering from a supplier on credit isn't built. The app's "Pay later" is for a trader's own customers.
[Handshake and streak]	[Order book] and [My record]	There's no handshake or streak screen yet. The order book and My record are built.
Akayza does that for business	Akayza builds that kind of history for a business	We don't lend. The record is the first step to credit, not credit itself.
a {3%} commission on orders	from R299 a month, plus about 1% on digital orders, never on cash	Our business model, slide 6.
customers with a repayment record	removed	No supplier credit yet, so no repayments to record.
lenders and insurers pay for verified histories	lenders pay to see a business's record, only with the owner's consent	Insurers aren't in the plan, and only provider-confirmed payments count as verified.

YOUR DRAFT	NOW	WHY
{50} businesses and {5} suppliers	2 suppliers and 50 to 100 businesses	The pilot plan, slide 6.
R{105,000}, covering hosting, field agents and compliance	R300,000: field agents, stipends, data, running costs and a POPIA review	The ask is the sum of the pilot's costs, slide 6.
proof; evidence, not just a receipt	a record people can trust; more than a receipt	Team rule: only a payment confirmed by the provider is proof.
We don't own the stock. We own the proof.	We don't hold the stock. We build the record.	A line earlier you say the record belongs to the owner, so "we own" contradicts it.
trust built him a mall	His customers trusted him, and decades later he opened Maponya Mall	Accurate: Dube Hygienic Dairy in the early 1950s, and Maponya Mall opened in 2007.
On building sites, groups	Banks and payment apps are	Dropped at your request. The new line
Kept as you wrote it: the pilot in Soshanguve. The deck doesn't name a place for the pilot, and the team's rule is that the project's "Where" is nationwide, so check with Mandla before the room.		

SOURCES

- R900 billion, under 9% with bank loans, about 80% unregistered: Standard Bank, Township Informal Economy Report, October 2025 ([Moneyweb](#), [Forbes Africa](#)).
- Spaza Shop Support Fund, R179.6m of R500m and 354 failed applications: DSBD briefing, 29 May 2026 ([SAnews](#)).
- Richard Maponya: [Daily Maverick](#), [Wikipedia](#).
- What the app does today: the Akayza code on 27 September 2026 (business types, orders and payments, order book, jobs and sign-off).